

JDScience 11+ English Practice Paper 1

English · Practice Paper 1

Name _____

Date _____

Score _____

Recommended time: 60 minutes

Questions: 40

Calculator: Not required unless a question says otherwise

Instructions

1. Work carefully and show clear thinking. For multiple-choice questions, choose the best answer.
2. If you cannot do a question, move on and return to it later if you have time.
3. Check your answers if you finish early.
4. This English paper is an original JDScience practice resource for 11+ preparation.
5. Read the passage carefully before answering the comprehension questions.
6. Section A has 25 comprehension questions. Section B has 15 language questions.

This is an original JDScience practice paper written for school entrance exam preparation. It is not an official GL Assessment, CEM, CSSE, school or publisher paper.

Section A — Reading

The Keeper of Greyhaven Light

Mist clung to the harbour like a damp grey curtain when Mira stepped onto the quay. The fishing boats rocked gently against their ropes, and somewhere beyond the breakwater the sea breathed in long, restless sighs. She tightened the strap of her satchel and glanced up at Greyhaven Light, a tall white tower perched on the headland. Its lamp had gone dark three nights ago, and every sailor in the village spoke of it in low, uneasy voices.

Mira's grandfather had been the lighthouse keeper for forty years. He knew the moods of the tide better than he knew the names of the people who lived ashore. When he fell ill last winter, the council appointed a temporary keeper called Mr Voss, a thin man with ink-stained fingers and a habit of speaking as if every sentence were a secret. Mira did not trust him. She had seen him leave the tower early on the night the light failed, walking quickly toward the old boathouse with something heavy wrapped in cloth.

Today she intended to find out what he had taken.

The path up the headland was steep and slippery with dew. Gorse scratched at her coat as she climbed. At the top, the wind arrived suddenly, cold and sharp, tasting of salt. The lighthouse door stood ajar. Mira paused, listening. Inside, a clock ticked with stubborn regularity, but otherwise the tower was silent. She slipped through the doorway and climbed the spiral stairs, her boots whispering against the stone.

On the lamp room floor she found a scatter of brass screws and a cracked lens panel. Someone had dismantled part of the mechanism and left it unfinished. Mira crouched and examined the damage. The main reflector was missing — the polished metal disc that threw the beam far across the water. Without it, the lamp was little more than a candle in a glass cage.

A floorboard creaked below. Mira froze. Footsteps climbed toward her, unhurried and certain. She ducked behind the lamp housing just as Mr Voss entered, carrying a canvas bag. He set it down, wiped his forehead, and muttered, "One more night and they'll never notice." He opened the bag. Inside, wrapped in oilcloth, lay the missing reflector, its surface still gleaming.

Mira's heart hammered. She understood then: he meant to sell it. The village would remain dark until a replacement arrived from the mainland, and by then the evidence would be gone. Ships approaching the reef would have only the stars — and stars were not enough in fog.

She stepped out from behind the housing. "Put it back," she said, surprised by the steadiness of her own voice.

Mr Voss spun round. For a moment his face showed only shock; then it hardened into something colder. "You shouldn't be here, girl. This is council business."

"It's my grandfather's light," Mira replied. "And you've stolen the heart of it."

He lunged for the bag, but Mira was closer. She seized the reflector and backed toward the stairs. The metal was heavier than she expected, cold against her palms. Mr Voss shouted and started after her. She ran, taking the steps two at a time, the tower spinning around her in a blur of white stone and shadow.

Outside, the mist had begun to thin. Down in the harbour, early fishermen were preparing their nets. Mira shouted as loudly as she could, "He's taken the reflector! Help!" Faces turned. Boots pounded on the quay.

Within minutes, two fishermen and Mrs Hale from the post office were climbing the path. Mr Voss, seeing them, stopped halfway down the slope, then tried to slip sideways into the gorse. He did not get far.

That evening, with the reflector restored and the lamp burning again, Mira stood beside her grandfather's chair. He was pale but smiling. "A keeper's first duty," he whispered, "is to remember who the light is for."

Mira looked out at the darkening sea, where a single bright beam swept the water in a steady arc. The mist had lifted. Far out, a freighter's horn sounded once — grateful, she thought, or perhaps only coincidental. Either way, Greyhaven Light was awake again, and so was she.

In the days that followed, the council replaced Mr Voss and asked Mira to help train the new keeper. She returned each afternoon after school, polishing brass, checking oil levels, and learning the names of every reef and sandbank marked on the old charts. She discovered that the work was quieter than she had imagined, full of small careful tasks rather than dramatic rescues. Yet each dusk, when the lamp flared into life and the first sweep of light crossed the waves, she felt the same fierce pride she had felt on the night she ran down the tower stairs with the stolen reflector in her arms.

Sometimes her grandfather joined her at the window, wrapped in a blanket, pointing out where the tide pulled hardest and where fog liked to gather. "You have good eyes," he told her. "Keep them open. The sea does not forgive carelessness, but it rewards those who watch." Mira nodded, memorising every word. She did not yet know whether she would become the official keeper one day. She only knew that Greyhaven mattered — to the sailors, to the village, and to the quiet man who had tended its light for forty years. And that, for now, was enough.

Section A — Questions

1. Where does Mira go at the start of the passage?
 - A. To the mainland ferry
 - B. Onto the quay by the harbour
 - C. Into Mr Voss's house
 - D. To the village school
 - E. Onto a fishing boat
2. How long had Mira's grandfather been the lighthouse keeper?

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3. Which word best describes Mira's feelings about Mr Voss before she enters the lighthouse?
 - A. Admiring
 - B. Indifferent
 - C. Suspicious
 - D. Grateful
 - E. Amused
4. What is Mr Voss said to have a habit of doing when he speaks?

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5. Why is the lighthouse important to the village?
 - A. It attracts tourists every summer
 - B. It stores the fishermen's nets
 - C. It guides ships safely, especially near the reef and in fog
 - D. It is used as the council meeting hall
 - E. It marks the border with the next county
6. What is missing from the lamp room when Mira first inspects it?

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7. "The sea breathed in long, restless sighs" is an example of:
 - A. Simile
 - B. Personification
 - C. Alliteration
 - D. Irony
 - E. Onomatopoeia

8. How does Mr Voss react when Mira first speaks to him in the lamp room?

- A. He laughs and apologises
- B. He immediately runs downstairs
- C. He is shocked, then becomes cold and defensive
- D. He offers her money to stay quiet
- E. He pretends not to hear her

Section A — Questions

9. What does Mira seize before running down the stairs?
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10. Which of the following best summarises Mira's main purpose in climbing to the lighthouse?
- A. To deliver a message from the council
 - B. To polish the brass for her grandfather
 - C. To discover what Mr Voss had taken
 - D. To measure the oil levels in the lamp
 - E. To watch for the freighter's arrival
11. Find and copy one phrase that shows the path up the headland was difficult to walk on.
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12. What does Mr Voss mean when he mutters, "One more night and they'll never notice"?
- A. He plans to repair the light before morning
 - B. He believes he can get away with the theft if he delays discovery a little longer
 - C. He thinks a storm will hide the dark lighthouse
 - D. He expects the council to thank him tomorrow
 - E. He is waiting for Mira's grandfather to recover
13. Who helps Mira after she shouts from the headland?
- A. Only the council members
 - B. Two fishermen and Mrs Hale from the post office
 - C. Mr Voss's assistants
 - D. Sailors from the freighter
 - E. Her grandfather and the schoolteacher
14. What does Mira's grandfather say a keeper's first duty is?
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15. How does the atmosphere change between the opening of the passage and the evening after the lamp is restored?
- A. From calm sunshine to violent storm
 - B. From uneasy mist and darkness to restored light and relief
 - C. From noisy celebration to complete silence
 - D. From winter ice to summer heat
 - E. From comedy to tragedy

16. What does Mira learn about lighthouse work in the days after the incident?

- A. It is mostly dramatic rescues at sea
- B. It is quieter than she imagined and full of small careful tasks
- C. It requires no training at all
- D. It is done only at weekends
- E. It involves travelling to other villages daily

Section A — Questions

17. Which statement about Mira is true by the end of the passage?
- A. She has already been appointed the official keeper
 - B. She has decided never to return to the lighthouse
 - C. She helps train the new keeper but is unsure about her future role
 - D. She moves to the mainland with her grandfather
 - E. She sells the reflector to the council
18. What advice does Mira's grandfather give her about the sea?
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19. "Mist clung to the harbour like a damp grey curtain" contains which two literary devices?
- A. Metaphor and hyperbole
 - B. Simile and imagery
 - C. Alliteration and irony
 - D. Personification and oxymoron
 - E. Pun and rhyme
20. Why might the writer describe Mira's boots as 'whispering against the stone'?
- A. To show that the boots are brand new
 - B. To emphasise how quietly and carefully she is moving
 - C. To suggest the lighthouse is haunted
 - D. To indicate that Mira is talking to herself
 - E. To prove the stairs are made of wood
21. In your own words, explain why Mira confronts Mr Voss instead of simply reporting him later.
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22. Which of these is the best title alternative for the passage?
- A. A Day at the Fish Market
 - B. The Stolen Beam
 - C. Mr Voss's Holiday
 - D. School on the Headland
 - E. The Broken Clock

23. What does the freighter's horn most likely suggest in the context of the ending?

- A. That a storm is approaching
- B. That Mira is being called home for supper
- C. That ships can once again rely on Greyhaven Light — or at least that traffic continues safely offshore
- D. That Mr Voss has escaped by sea
- E. That the lighthouse has failed again

24. Give one piece of evidence that Mira feels proud after the light is restored.

Section A — Questions

- 25.** Overall, what is the main theme of the passage?
- A. Friendship is more important than honesty
 - B. Responsibility and courage in protecting others
 - C. Technology makes traditional skills useless
 - D. Children should never question adults
 - E. Village life is dull and unimportant

Section B — Spelling, punctuation, grammar and vocabulary

- 26.** Which sentence is punctuated correctly?
- A. Mira asked, "Is the lamp working tonight."
 - B. Mira asked, "Is the lamp working tonight?"
 - C. Mira asked "Is the lamp working tonight?"
 - D. Mira asked, "is the lamp working tonight?"
 - E. Mira asked; "Is the lamp working tonight?"
- 27.** Choose the correct spelling to complete the sentence: The sailors waited for the official ____ from the council.
- A. announcement
 - B. annoucement
 - C. anouncement
 - D. announcemant
 - E. announce ment
- 28.** Which word is a synonym for 'uneasy' as used in the passage ('uneasy voices')?
- A. Cheerful
 - B. Anxious
 - C. Silent
 - D. Proud
 - E. Careless
- 29.** Identify the adjective in this sentence: 'The cold wind tasted of salt.'
- A. wind
 - B. tasted
 - C. cold
 - D. salt
 - E. of
- 30.** Which sentence uses an apostrophe correctly?
- A. The boats rope's were tangled.
 - B. The boat's ropes were tangled.
 - C. The boats' rope's were tangled.
 - D. The boat ropes' were tangled.
 - E. The boats ropes were tangled'.

31. Choose the correct verb form: Neither of the fishermen _____ willing to wait.

- A. were
- B. are
- C. was
- D. be
- E. have been

32. Which word is an antonym of 'ajar'?

- A. Open
- B. Shut
- C. Broken
- D. Heavy
- E. Narrow

33. Select the sentence that is grammatically correct.

- A. Mira and me climbed the headland.
- B. Mira and I climbed the headland.
- C. Me and Mira climbed the headland.
- D. I and Mira climbs the headland.
- E. Mira and I climbs the headland.

Section B — Spelling, punctuation, grammar and vocabulary

- 34.** In the sentence 'She discovered that the work was quieter than she had imagined,' the word 'quieter' is:
- A. A comparative adjective
 - B. A superlative adjective
 - C. An adverb of manner
 - D. A preposition
 - E. A collective noun
- 35.** Which sentence needs a comma after the opening phrase?
- A. After school Mira returned to the tower.
 - B. Mira polished the brass carefully.
 - C. The lamp burned brightly.
 - D. Fishermen prepared their nets.
 - E. Greyhaven stood on the headland.
- 36.** Choose the correctly spelled word:
- A. seperate
 - B. separate
 - C. seperete
 - D. separete
 - E. separrate
- 37.** Which punctuation mark best completes this sentence? 'Watch the reef carefully____ ships have struck it before.'
- A. .
 - B. ,
 - C. ;
 - D. ?
 - E. !
- 38.** What does the prefix 'un-' do in the word 'unfinished'?
- A. It makes the word plural
 - B. It turns the word into a noun
 - C. It gives the word the opposite meaning
 - D. It shows past tense
 - E. It shows possession

39. Choose the word closest in meaning to 'stubborn' in 'a clock ticked with stubborn regularity'.

- A. Occasional
- B. Reluctant
- C. Persistent
- D. Musical
- E. Broken

40. Which sentence is in the passive voice?

- A. Mira restored the reflector.
- B. The fishermen climbed the path.
- C. The reflector was restored that evening.
- D. Mr Voss carried a canvas bag.
- E. The mist lifted from the harbour.